In 1954, the Government of India enacted a Central Prevention of Food Adulteration Act. The act has been amended several times, the latest amendment is that of 1976 and in lately in 1986 to make the Act more stringent.

Although it is a Central Act, its implementation is largely carried out by the local bodies and State Governments.

Food Standards

FAO/WHO formulates food standards for international market. Codex Alimentarius commission which is the principal organ of the joint FAO/ WHO food standards programme. The standards in India are based on the standards of the Codex Alimentarius.

PFA Standards

Under the Prevention of Food Adulteration Act, 1954 standards have been established which are revised from time to time by the "Central Committee for Food standards".

The purpose of PFA standards is to obtain a minimum level of quality of foodstuffs attainable under India conditions.

The Agmark Standards

These standards are set by the Directorate of Marketing and Inspection of the Government of India.

Bureau of India Standards

The ISI mark on any article of food is a guarantee of food quality in accordance with the standards prescribed by the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) for that commodity.

SUMMARY

- Nutrition is the science of food and its relationship to health. It is concerned with the part played by nutrients in body growth, development and maintenance.
- Good nutrition is essential for attainment of normal growth and development during fetal life and childhood. Physical growth, intellectual development, learning and behavior are affected by malnutrition.
- Adequate nutrition is needed for adult life maintenance for optimum health and efficiency.
- Carbohydrates are the main source of energy for daily activities. Carbohydrates (primarily starches) are the least expensive, the most plentifully available, easily obtainable and readily digested form of nutrient.
- The lipids are a heterogeneous group of substances found in plant and animal tissues, which share the property of being relatively insoluble in water, and soluble in organic solvents, such as ether, chloroform and benzene.
- Proteins are polymer chains made of amino acids linked together by peptide bonds. Amino acids can be divided into essential amino acids and non – essential amino acids. Proteins and carbohydrates contain 4 kcal per gram as opposed to lipids which contain 9 kcal per gram of energy.
- Vitamins are essential organic, compounds that are needed in small amounts in the diet both to prevent deficiency diseases and to support optimal health. The term vitamin (vital amines) was coined by Casmir Funk. The term vital denoting essential for life and amines because these compounds contained an amine functional group.
- The four fat – soluble vitamins – vitamins A, D, E and K are often present in the fat portion of foods, they are not easily lost from foods or destroyed by exposure to water, heat, air, or light.

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